



ROUNDUP

December 2023

Dear Readers

As we kick start the new year, we want to express our heartfelt gratitude to all our members, leaders, collaborators, and other key players of the entrepreneurial ecosystem for supporting and being a part of ABWCI's Global Community!

Reflecting on our impact in 2023, we celebrate significant milestones in enabling and celebrating women entrepreneurs worldwide. We aim to shape an even more impactful year by creating countless growth opportunities and advocating for women-centric entrepreneurial ecosystems.

ABWCI is committed to fostering greater influence, innovation, and inspiration. Roll up your sleeves, as we are bringing together a lot of exciting updates soon, some of which have been highlighted in this edition of ABWCI's Roundup. Check it out and get ready for what's yet to come! Happy reading!

INSIDE THIS EDITION

- Spotlight
- Country Chapters
- Highlights of the Quarter
- Celebrating #GEW2023
- Decoding Leadership

SPOTLIGHT

2023 IMPACT

30+

Countries reached
and engaged

30+

Collaborations and
Partnerships Signed

\$15M

Funds mobilized for
women entrepreneurs

130K

Women entrepreneurs
connected

200+

Women owned & run
businesses spotted

50+

Events organised for
women entrepreneurs



WELCOMING

Aneta Szulc
Country President, Poland

Aneta Szulc is a highly accomplished professional in the logistics and supply chain industry, currently serving as the Managing Partner of Independent Logistics. Being passionate about empowering women, Aneta actively engages in mentorship programs, advocating for gender diversity and equal opportunities.

COUNTRY CHAPTERS



ARGENTINA

- Regional President, South America, Dr. Graciela De Oto awarded a 'Doctorate in Business Administration' from Glory International University.
- Dr. Graciela De Oto launched her book titled, 'Las Constituciones del Mundo & la Brecha Salarial' (The Constitutions of the World & the Wage Gap) on the International Day for Equal Pay. [Get your copy here!](#)
- Dr. Graciela De Oto was on the jury of the 'TOYP Awards'. The awards recognizes young leaders who aim to bring a positive change to the world.
- Dr. Graciela De Oto's organisation 'Suma Veritas Foundation' awarded a Diploma of Recognition for its exceptional commitment and valuable contribution to advancing consensus in support of gender policies.
- Suma Veritas Foundation's 'Red Bag Campaign For Gender Equality' featured in the 'Gender Equality & Women's Empowerment Thematic Book' by the C20 Working Group 2023 (G20).

DOMINICAN REPUBLIC

- Country President, Dominican Republic, Neris Mercedes Ramos Acevedo supported the event titled "The Role of Women in the Implementation of the 2030 Agenda."
- Neris Mercedes Ramos Acevedo moderated a panel titled "The Role of Women in Market Dominican Automotive - Gender Vision" at the Anadive Convention & Expo 2023.
- Neris Mercedes Ramos Acevedo successfully completed the IMESUN (Start and Improve Your Business) business management training program in collaboration with the International Labor Organization (ILO).
- Neris Mercedes Ramos Acevedo's organisation, NGestiónRD organised 'Talk On World Day of the Fights Against Breast Cancer by Dr. Natalia Guzmán' in partnership with Dominican American University, International SDG Promoters Network, the Emprende Junior Emprendejr Program, and ABWCI.
- Neris Mercedes Ramos Acevedo moderated a session titled 'Female Entrepreneurship: A Reflective Look from Business Mentoring' for celebration of the Global Entrepreneurship Week.

KOREA

- Global Ambassador, Odino Faccia and his team successfully organised a Concert for Peace and Values at the Pajo World Peace Park, Seoul. Odino created history by performing at the border between North and South Korea.



NIGERIA

- Regional President, South America, Dr. Graciela De Oto appointed as the International Advisor of Amity College University, Nigeria.
- Dr. Graciela De Oto honoured with the 'Global Humanitarian & Social Record' by the Notable Book of World Records, Nigeria for humanity, educational support & community development.



PHILIPPINES

- Country President, Philippines, Phoebe G. David organised, KALEIDOSCOPE, an intercultural art exhibit to promote women artists. The event showcased paintings of various established and emerging visual artists.



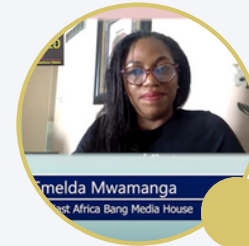
SINGAPORE

- Country President, Singapore, Lilian Ong spoke at the 'Building Courageous Women Leaders 2023 Women Leadership Conference'. She shared her insights on how to excel in your career and the importance of mental health.
- Lilian Ong honoured with Singapore's '40-over-40 Inspiring Women Award 2023' under the Social Contributors category.



TANZANIA

- Country President, Tanzania, Emelda Mwamanga, featured in 'The Brand Called You' in the episode titled, 'A Journey of Belief and Persistence'.



UGANDA

- CEO, Dr. Ambika Sharma shared her thoughts on menstrual hygiene for young girls and women at the Health & Wellness Session organised by Kisa Kya Mukama Outreach Foundation & CreativExpression.



UK

- Global Ambassador, Rabih El Fadel spoke at the International Conclave at the Palace of Westminster. The event highlighted the importance of sustainable development.
- Rabih El Fadel participated in a dialogue at the COP28 & Sustainable Development Summit organised by the Arab-British Chamber of Commerce and Kantar Advisory Partners.



USA

- Global Ambassador, Larisa B. Miller featured in the Corporate Investment Times for a monthly column in the series titled "The Future Of Enterprise: Part 4, Nurturing Growth Through Inclusion And Empowerment".
- State President, Texas, Anjum Malik featured amongst the finalists for the 'Exceptional Women of Peace Award' by the Culture of Peace Initiative.
- Larisa B. Miller featured in the Corporate Investment Times for a monthly column in the series titled "The Future Of Enterprise: Part 5, The loneliness of entrepreneurship".

INDIA

- State President, Rajasthan, Alka Batra spoke at the Entrepreneurial Summit on Cultivating Rajasthan Startup Ecosystem for Sustainable Growth, organized by Atal Incubation Centre.
- CEO, Dr. Ambika Sharma was on the jury of 'The Falling Walls' Pitch Competition organised by Atal Community Innovation Center and Sanrachna Foundation at SGT University.
- Legal Advisor, Dhruv Manchanda announced as a verified member of StartupLanes, for providing specialized legal services to start-ups and businesses.
- Member, Shailza Taneja honoured with the 'Best Founder Female of the Year 2023 with Social Impact Award' at the India Startup Summit & Startup Achievers Awards.
- ABWCI supported NHRDN's DEIB Summit, Samaaveshan 2023 as a knowledge partner. The summit's aim was to enable and encourage how DEIB can help individuals in everyday life.
- State President, Karnataka, Chayaa Nanjappa Rajappa was invited as the guest of honour at the 'Webinar on Honey Processing and Value Addition' organised by National Institute of Food Technology, Entrepreneurship and Management, Thanjavur (NIFTEM-T).
- State President, Telangana & Andhra Pradesh, Kavitha Rajesh, participated in the Networking Meet and Entrepreneur Acceleration Program (EAP) Inauguration organised by International Labour Organization (ILO) at Visakhapatnam.

INDIA

- ABWCI felicitated with the 'Partners in Progress' award by the Governor of Karnataka during the 'Together We Grow' Conference organized by the Ubuntu Consortium.
- Kavitha Rajesh guided ACABC students from agriculture, animal husbandry, and veterinary backgrounds on opportunities to turn their ideas into businesses.
- Member, Saakshi Arora Katyal (Founder, Jade Xclusive) was listed amongst the '5 Most Promising Entrepreneurs from Chandigarh in 2023' by Outlook India.
- CauldronSisterss (Member, Ratika Bhargava's organisation) launched a food talk titled, 'The Sisters Table', a monthly food cultural exchange programme where individuals bond and share their stories over food.
- CauldronSisterss featured in the article 'Chat over Chaat Boards this Navratri' by The Hindu and Dainik Bhaskar.
- CauldronSisterss hosted a mini edition of 'The Sisters Table' on the occasion of Children's Day. The event aimed to curate an immersive experience to instil a sense of community amongst children.





ABWCI IS ON THE SOCIAL STOCK EXCHANGE

#WomenInVyapaar

ABWCI
Association of Business Women in Commerce & Industry

is on the Social Stock Exchange!

ABWCI listed on the Social Stock Exchange (National Stock Exchange, India) – reflecting on our commitment to social impact and responsible business practices. The SSE segment on NSE provides Social Enterprises (Non-profit organizations) engaged in eligible activities a unique opportunity to register itself and raise funds on a recognized exchange platform. The SSE is a platform designed to facilitate access to a broader capital base for social enterprises and voluntary organizations operating within the social sector, further strengthening their capacity to drive positive change.

#DidYouKnow

The Hon'ble Finance Minister of India, Smt. Nirmala Sitharaman as part of the Budget Speech for FY 2019-20 proposed the idea of an electronic fund-raising platform "Social Stock Exchange", under the regulatory ambit of SEBI for listing social enterprises and voluntary organizations working for the realization of a social welfare objective so that they can raise capital as equity, debt or as units like a mutual fund.

Source: NSE India

[Click Here to Know More](#)



Celebrating #WorldMentalHealthDay October 10, 2023

LET'S TALK
ABOUT

MENTAL
HEALTH

The overall objective of World Mental Health Day is to raise awareness about mental health issues around the world and to mobilize efforts in support of mental health.

Source: World Health Organisation

ABWCI and Women Inspiring Network organised a mentoring walk on World Mental Health Day dedicated to supporting the mental wellbeing and empowerment of women.

Mental health advocates and influencers shared their insights on importance of mental health for women.

[Click here to listen to our CEO's Message](#)



CELEBRATING GLOBAL ENTREPRENEURSHIP WEEK (GEW)



The **GEW** is an awareness campaign engaging millions of people each November through thousands of events that celebrate entrepreneurs and inspire others – particularly those who face structural barriers or may have never considered the idea of launching a startup.

Throughout November, ABWCI's Global Secretariat was engaged in celebrating women in business via the social campaign **#BoostYourBrand**, under **Women in Vyapaar**. **#BoostYourBrand** is a testament of ABWCI's commitment towards spotlighting the efforts of women in business.

Check out the messages from ABWCI's leaders for women entrepreneurs and the highlights of **#BoostYourBrand** on Instagram!

Click here to watch now!



**Glimpses
from
#GEW2023**

BUYER-SELLER MEET

The Buyer - Seller Meet of the last quarter of 2023 provided a dynamic platform for women entrepreneurs to network and collaborate.

Through engaging conversations and demonstrations, the entrepreneurs showcased their products and services which led to the

development of business opportunities & synergies. ABWCI is organising a wide range of events, conferences, and meet-ups to further the agenda of women's social & economic empowerment.



7 Q U E S T I O N S

L E A D E R S H I P

With Dr. Graciela De Oto

ABWCI's Regional President, South America



1. What have you found most challenging as a leader?

As a leader in gender and women's entrepreneurship, navigating entrenched cultural norms poses a complex challenge. Breaking gender-based barriers requires persistence and an understanding of various intricacies. Challenges include dismantling stereotypes, addressing disparities in resources, battling systemic biases, and managing individual perceptions. Despite facing resistance, leading in this space is rewarding. Overcoming difficulties serves as a testament to collective determination, reaffirming the importance of reshaping the narrative of gender & entrepreneurship for a prosperous society.

2. How did you become a leader? Can you please briefly tell the story?

My leadership originates from a passion for empowering women & advocating for gender equality. Beginning as a volunteer, I discerned the imperative for change and the untapped potential in women. Over the years, my commitment to advancing this agenda resulted in increased responsibilities and recognition. Recognized for my advocacy of gender equality, I seized opportunities to lead initiatives and founded the 'Suma Veritas Foundation.' Throughout my journey, I have learned that leadership is about making an impact and inspiring positive change, underscoring the transformative power of passion and dedication.

3. How do you structure your work days from waking up to going to sleep?

My daily routine prioritizes a balance between professional responsibilities, family, dogs, and self-care. I commence the day with breakfast and morning exercises, concentrating on strategic planning, team meetings, and engaging with partners during work hours. I ensure my dogs receive attention through daily walks and playtime, infusing joy into my day. Evenings are dedicated to reviewing progress and preparing for the next day, with allocated time for relaxation and reflection. Although balancing these elements is challenging, it is crucial for well-being and effective leadership.



4. What is one meaningful story that comes to mind from your time as a leader, so far?

A profoundly meaningful moment in my leadership journey occurred when we successfully partnered with the local government (Buenos Aires, Argentina) to launch a women's entrepreneurship program. Witnessing women overcome barriers and transform business ideas into thriving ventures was heart-warming and inspiring. This experience underscored the profound impact of empowerment on individuals and communities, reinforcing the belief that fostering equal opportunities benefits society as a whole. As a leader, witnessing individuals achieve remarkable feats reinforces the importance of advancing gender equality and creating environments where everyone has a fair chance to succeed. This experience remains a constant source of motivation, highlighting the transformative power of inclusive leadership.

5. What's a recent leadership lesson you've learned for the first time or been reminded of?

A recent leadership lesson emphasized the nuanced nature of 'sorority' among women in gender & women's entrepreneurship. While strong bonds & support exist, divisions and competition can also arise. It is crucial to recognize that sisterhood requires cultivation. Differences in opinions and approaches may lead to tensions, necessitating leaders to advocate for gender equality and foster inclusivity. Addressing challenges within female communities requires honest conversations, empathy, and active efforts to build unity. This highlights the importance of a collective impact.

6. What's one book that has had a profound impact on your leadership so far? Can you please briefly tell the story of how that book impacted your leadership?

Sheryl Sandberg's 'Lean In' profoundly influenced my leadership style, offering a compelling perspective on gender dynamics in the workplace. The book inspired me to unapologetically embrace leadership roles, emphasizing mentorship, self-advocacy, and seizing opportunities. It encouraged proactive engagement in my journey, pushing boundaries and advocating for gender equality. Sandberg's insights on mentorship motivated me to become a mentor, emphasizing the importance of a supportive network. The book also prompted me to challenge stereotypes, reinforcing the role of a leader in breaking down barriers and advocating for inclusivity beyond comfort zones.

7. If you could only give one piece of advice to a young leader, what would you say to them?

One vital piece of advice for young leaders is to never underestimate the power of networking & cultivating meaningful relationships. Networking involves building genuine connections with individuals who can positively influence your leadership journey. This skill opens doors to opportunities, broadens perspectives, & offers valuable insights. Connecting with people from diverse backgrounds provides access to a wealth of knowledge & potential mentors, enriching your understanding. It also creates a support system for guidance during both challenges & the celebration of successes. The relationships formed can lead to collaborations, partnerships, and opportunities & easily discovered alone.

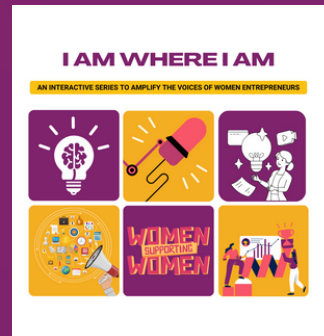
Embracing Opportunities, Envisioning Tomorrow!

WATCH THIS SPACE

The Leaders of ABWCI have been invited to the INVESTORS SUMMIT 2024 in Lisbon (February, 2024). The summit is a global platform for connecting business owners & investors.



Get ready for Season 1 of 'I AM WHERE I AM', an informal chat show based on candid conversations with women in business to break barriers and shatter myths one conversation at a time.



Women Shaping Trade Futures, an engaging dialogue with women leaders to share how women entrepreneurs are shaping the future of trade & creating an impact globally. Coming to your screens soon!



CONTACT US

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